Case Study on Getting Started with Zoho Creator: Account Setup and a Form-Based Application

Name:	Irwin Inbadurai V.J	**Reg. No.:**	241201018
Course:		**Date:**	

Aim

To set up a Zoho Creator account and build a working form-based application, understanding how forms, fields, reports and permissions fit together.

Objectives

- Create a Zoho account and open the Creator workspace.
- Design a form with suitable field types and validations.
- Test data entry and view submitted records in the automatically created report.
- Share the application with different types of users.

Selected Application

Campus Workshop Registration (illustrative). A college department runs several technical workshops every semester. Registrations currently arrive through paper slips and chat messages, so lists are incomplete and seats are over-booked. A simple form-based application will collect registrations in one place.

Step 1: Account Setup

No.	Action	Remark
1	Open the Zoho Creator website and choose the free trial / sign-up option	A Zoho account is required
2	Register using e-mail, create a password and verify the e-mail	Choose the correct data centre region
3	Log in and open the Creator home screen	Workspace lists your applications
4	Select **Create Application**, then **Start from scratch**	Other options include templates and AI prompts
5	Name the application 'Workshop Registration'	Names should be meaningful

Note: Plan names, limits and trial length change over time, so they should be confirmed on the Zoho pricing page on the day of the experiment.

Step 2: Understand the Building Blocks

A **form** collects and stores data and plays the role of a table in a database or a sheet in a spreadsheet. A form is made of **fields**, each with a type designed for one kind of data. When a form is created, Zoho Creator automatically produces a **list report** in table layout, and more reports can be added on the same form.

Step 3: Design the Registration Form

Field label	Field type	Setting / validation
Student Name	Name	Mandatory
Register Number	Single line	Mandatory, unique (no duplicates)
Department	Dropdown	BCA, BSc CS, BCom CA, Other
Year of Study	Radio	I, II, III
Mobile	Phone number	Mandatory
E-mail	Email	Mandatory, format checked
Workshop	Dropdown	Web Design, Data Analysis, Cloud Basics
Food Preference	Radio	Veg, Non-veg
Registration Date	Date	Default: today

Step 4: Build and Test

- Drag fields from the field palette on to the form canvas and set properties in the right panel.
- Choose **Access** and open the form in live mode to enter 5 to 10 sample records.
- Submit a record with a blank mandatory field and a duplicate register number to confirm the validations.
- Open the report to confirm that submitted data is stored and searchable.

Test Cases

Test case	Input	Expected result	Observed (to record)
Valid entry	All fields filled	Record saved, appears in report	
Missing mobile	Mobile blank	Error: field mandatory	
Duplicate	Same register number	Error: value already exists	
Bad e-mail	name@@mail	Format error	

Step 5: Share the Application

By default an application is private. The owner can invite users and assign them roles in the Share option, so that the faculty coordinator can see all registrations while students can only reach the form.

Role	Access given
Coordinator	Add, edit, view and export all records
Student	Submit registration only
HOD	View reports only

Results

- A working registration application was created in a short time without writing code.
- Automatic reports eliminated manual compilation of lists.
- Validations prevented incomplete and duplicate entries.

Conclusion

Starting with a form is the easiest way to learn Zoho Creator because every other component, such as reports, pages and workflows, depends on form data. This exercise shows that account setup, form design and testing can be done by a beginner, and it provides the base on which later experiments can be built.

Sources consulted: Zoho Creator Help documentation (forms, reports, pages, workflows, Deluge); Zoho Corporation press release on Creator AI features (April 2025) and its coverage in IT Brief; Zoho Creator Decode article on Zia-assisted Deluge (March 2026). The business scenario in this report is illustrative, and figures in it are assumed values used to demonstrate the method, not measured results.